PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Stigma towards leprosy across seven life domains in Indonesia: a qualitative systematic review
AUTHORS	Marpaung, Yosi; Ernawati, Ernawati; Dwivania, Agatha

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Tantut Susanto Universitas Jember, Community, Family, Geriatric Nursing
REVIEW RETURNED	22-May-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	Dear Authors, The manuscript entitled "Domains of life affected by stigma towards leprosy-affected people in Indonesia, the drivers, manifestations, and consequences: A qualitative systematic review" is important issues for treatment and caring of LAPS. However, some issues that identified in his study: The major problem is the standard English language of this manuscript. Please use English Proof to improve your written if you are not native English. 1. Introduction. Please pay attention about the problems of the study. The authors should describe what is the problem of this study, what is the solution and what is the outcome of study. The introduction is not concise, please describe more clearly the life experiences of stigma of LAPS in Indonesia. We think that many studies of LAPS that already published for explanation this phenomenon. Then, the characteristic of unique program in Indonesia setting. Then, the objective of study is not clearly mention in this study. 2. Method. Please using PRISMA checklist to guide your manuscript. We think that many items that loose from PRISMA checklist that you used in Supplementary file. Please add some items, including inclusion and exclusion criteria, Keyowords that used to search the manuscript? PICOs question formulas? etc.... 3. Results. Regarding the table 1, the authors should re-check again their search strategy and regarding the PRISMA diagram, please pay attention for 4 steps in PRISMA? 4. Discussion. What is the good and the bad your study finding? What is the limitation and the implication for practice from your study? 5. Conclusion. Please re-write your conclusion regarding your research objective. 6. references. Please add more references from LAPs research in Indonesia and using journal guidelines.

	Thank you. Sincerely yours, Reviewer

REVIEWER	Dadun Dadun Universitas Indonesia, CHRUI
REVIEW RETURNED	23-May-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	please add the limitation of this review, so other can improve it in the future

REVIEWER	Cristina Juan Jimenez Universidad de Alcalá
REVIEW RETURNED	13-Jul-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	General technical issues - Avoid searching in search engines with little scientific evidence as Google Scholar - Reviewing, grouping in order and sorting bibliographic citations (as in the model sheet). Example: " Leprosy has been and still is an illness in oblivion, underdiagnosed and highly stigmatised in society whilst impacting the lives of people [1-3]. " This is an example of grouping: 1,2,3 and sytle. It is important name references in order For example in your text "Enacted,2,8,33,34,39,40,43–45,47–49,22,50–52,54–56,23,26–31" It is wrong. Correctly should be: "[2,8,22,23,26-31,33,34,39,40,43-45,47,49-52,54-56] Improvements to be made in the article - Review title (English comprenhesion) - Review abstract: Included number of articles in data extraction, not in results - Reviewing keywords, adding new ones - Table 2 should appear after referencing it in the text, not before. - Explain the meaning of each acronym in the table (C, D...). Example Comunity (C) - Expand the study with data base Atlas.ti for grouping concepts in order to write so many subindex of references -Subdividing by items or subsection each domain to be more clear improving text comprehension - Explain more CASP in the explanation of the study selection - In the reference of a figure, writting the text in the middle and with the reference corresponding (As an example in the document attached, it is in Spaninish but you can follow the reference and formatting template for tables and figures - Introduce the suplement material with the name of table and after to the text where you speak about them - Lack of explanation of our limitations in our study. For example: difficulties to find documents, to read the documents, to choose the articles, to find the keywords.. (or others. It depends) - Part of the conclusions very terse I would like to congragulate your work in spite of my comments. Don´t hesitate to contact me if you have any question

REVIEWER	Yudhy Dharmawan University Medical Center Rotterdam, Public Health
REVIEW RETURNED	14-Jul-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	I believe this research is significant in revealing the domains of life affected by stigma towards leprosy-affected people in Indonesia, so it can help leprosy and social community program in Indonesia to overcome the impact of leprosy stigma in the community. To make this paper better readable for the readers and in line with the Systematic Review approach, I give my comments as follows: Objective : Rows 3-4(Page 3): Objective: To provide knowledge about the domains of life affected by stigma on leprosy affected persons in Indonesia, the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and consequences. According to the PRISMA guideline (Please see checklist number 4), the objective must provide an explicit statement of questions being addressed with reference to participants, interventions, comparisons, outcomes, and study design (PICOS). What are the 'Compare' and 'Outcome' in this objective? Will the authors make a comparison of the Intervention or not? Are the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and the consequences outcome? Please make it clear in the Objective section, so it can be a direction to analyse and discuss this study. Method : Rows 40-53 (Eligibility & Search Strategy) (Page 4) The PICO(S) is not described in the method as the PRISMA guideline requirement (Please see checklist numbers 6 & 8). PICO(S) is very important to define the eligibility studies that can be included in the Systematic Review and the specific terms that will be used as the search strategy. Please state what is the Population, Intervention/Exposure, Compare, Outcome and Study design explicitly in the method section? The authors did not mention the kind of peer-reviewed and grey literature included in this study. Please state it explicitly and how did it conduct in this study? If there is no grey literature, please provide an argument about it. Rows 52-53 (Page 4): Search terms used stigma, leprosy, driver, manifestations, and consequences and their synonyms as keywords. What is the "search term" function in this method section? What is different with supplement material 1 (Syntaxes for search)? Did the authors do a double search strategy? What are the actual specific terms that were used in the search strategy? Please explain it clearly in the method section. As long as my knowledge, the search strategy should be defined after describing the PICO(S). Did the authors do a meta-analysis or only a narrative analysis? Please state this method explicitly in the method with its reason. As the mentioned in PRISMA guideline as the supplement material, this study provided meta-analysis results, but it is not written in the results section. Please explain this issue. The authors did not explain the analysis and synthesis plan explicitly and clearly. It is only mentioned used Theme analysis (Row 7, page 5), but there is no description of this method's procedure, so that can make a result as written on pages 8-12. How did the authors categorise all the themes to be subgroup/subheadings as reported on pages 8-12? How did the authors analyse the stigma domain with the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and the consequences of stigma? Please explain the analysis and synthesis

	plan clearly in the method section so that it can give the analysis result as written in the result section. Results If possible, please make the crosstabulation of the stigma domain with the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and the consequences of stigma to describe the results of analysis or synthesis in this study so the readers can see it easily in the summarising presented in the table. This suggestion to meet the requirements of PRISMA guidelines (Please see checklist number 20) Please write the results according to the analysis and synthesis data plan that is mentioned in the method section. Discussion I suggest providing the main finding in this study, for instance, the predominant stigma domain in LAP of Indonesia in the summary part of the discussion section and discussing this factor to overcome the stigma among LAP in Indonesia. There is no discussion about the limitation of this study as the requirement of the PRISMA Guideline (Please see checklist number 25) The conclusion is very general. There is no specific finding that can be revealed from this study. I believe if the authors can revise the objective according to the PICOS criteria, this study's interesting conclusion can be made because the results and discussion will be more focused. Supplement material: Please the authors check and revise the supplement material of the PRISMA guideline, especially the page number that contains the item checklist and also, please mention the number supplement material specifically. Many checklist items are not appropriate for text/manuscript pages. Several checklist entries were claimed in the text, but nothing was written in the text as per my comment above after I checked.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer: 1
Dr. Tantut Susanto, Universitas Jember Comments to the Author:
Dear Authors,

The manuscript entitled "Domains of life affected by stigma towards leprosy-affected people in Indonesia, the drivers, manifestations, and consequences: A qualitative systematic review" is important issues for treatment and caring of LAPS. However, some issues that identified in his study:
The major problem is the standard English language of this manuscript. Please use English Proof to improve your written if you are not native English.
Author response: Thank you very much Dr Tantut for this remark. We believe this is very important. We will note. Thank you.

1. Introduction. Please pay attention about the problems of the study. The authors should describe what is the problem of this study, what is the solution and what is the outcome of study. The introduction is not concise, please describe more clearly the life experiences of stigma of LAPS in Indonesia. We think that many studies of LAPS that already published for explanation this phenomenon. Then, the characteristic of unique program in Indonesia setting. Then, the objective of study is not clearly mention in this study.
Author response: Thank you for this Dr Tantut. We agree that the introduction should be clear. We have tried to make the life experience as concise as possible to allow more room for the result and

discussion and to addressed word limit. The 3rd paragraph has contained the problem, solution offered, and the outcome of this study. As of the objective statement, we agree that there is a bit confusion. We have improved it.
Hopefully, it is now increasing the comprehensibility. Thank you for your suggestion regarding the unique program in Indonesia setting. While we agree that this is an interesting topic to be addressed, we see that it seemed not fit the core themes of the research. Yet, we already note in paragraph 2 and 3 some impression to the national situation. As of program, we noticed that even though improvement is there, the program implementations at least in the last 10 years still didn't reach a desired result in Indonesia as the decline in the number of LAPs is slow and Indonesia is still in the third rank of global leprosy cases.

2. Method. Please using PRISMA checklist to guide your manuscript. We think that many items that loose from PRISMA checklist that you used in Supplementary file. Please add some items, including inclusion and exclusion criteria, Keyowords that used to search the manuscript? PICOs question formulas? etc....
Author response: Thank you very much Dr Tantut for this. We appreciate your input. As the editor also suggested, we have changed our PRISMA checklist form 2009 to 2020 version. We have filled and attached it in the system. We have incorporated the inclusion and exclusion criteria in the main article. As for the PICOs, we used PICo (Population, Interest, Context) instead as this is more suitable for the qualitative studies. We have added this information in the method section.

3. Results. Regarding the table 1, the authors should re-check again their search strategy and regarding the PRISMA diagram, please pay attention for 4 steps in PRISMA?

Author response: Thank you very much Dr Tantut for this. We have rechecked the search strategy and we conclude that it was sufficient to receive the targeted literature based on the inclusion criteria. In table 1, we apologize that there is a bit information i.e the type of publication whether article journal or grey literature, and the language that we already extracted yet could not be displayed there, due to a minimum of 2 pages table in the manuscript. We have modified the table optimally; however, we could not fit the table into 1 page. To compensate, we stated the numbers of scholarly journal article and language in the text. Regarding the stigma the 4 steps of PRISMA, the identification, screening, eligibility, and inclusion had been followed. We hope we understand your comment correctly.

4. Discussion. What is the good and the bad your study finding? What is the limitation and the implication for practice from your study?
Author response: Thank you, we appreciate this very much. We agree that the limitation part of our study was still very minimally inserted in the main article. We have added the limitation part in the discussion section.

5. Conclusion. Please re-write your conclusion regarding your research objective.
Author response: Thank you Dr. Tantut we agree that our conclusion was very terse. We have improved it in the main article.

6. References. Please add more references from LAPs research in Indonesia and using journal guidelines.
Author response: We appreciate your suggestion. However, due the specific context of our study design which is about exploring the literature from the Indonesia's context, we perceive that there were already a spacious room to discuss for the LAP research from Indonesia's context. We use literature under a general theme and to discuss it from the fundamental knowledge of stigma.

Thank you. Sincerely yours, Reviewer

Reviewer: 2
Dr. Dadun Dadun , Universitas Indonesia Comments to the Author:
please add the limitation of this review, so other can improve it in the future
Author response: Thank you very much Dr Dadun for this. I believe this is very important. We have added the limitation part in the main article.

Reviewer: 3
Dr. Cristina Juan Jimenez , Universidad de Alcalá Comments to the Author:
General technical issues
- Avoid searching in search engines with little scientific evidence as Google Scholar

Author response: Thank you very much Dr Cristina for this comment. We agree with you. However, many local studies either peer-reviewed articles or thesis that were written in the Indonesian language were not published in the international databases. Thus, we used Google Scholar which is connected with local universities repositories and local peer-reviewed journals. We used Google Scholar to complement our findings with Pubmed, Cinahl, Taylor&Francis, and Proquest databases. We have put a little note on the search strategy part.

- Reviewing, grouping in order and sorting bibliographic citations (as in the model sheet). Example: " Leprosy has been and still is an illness in oblivion, underdiagnosed and highly stigmatised in society whilst impacting the lives of people [1-3]. " This is an example of grouping: 1,2,3 and sytle. It is important name references in order For example in your text "Enacted,2,8,33,34,39,40,43–45,47–49,22,50–52,54–56,23,26–31" It is wrong. Correctly should be: "[2,8,22,23,26-31,33,34,39,40,43-45,47,49-52,54-56]
Author response: Thank you very much Dr Cristina for noticing this. We have checked all the text and fix the order of citation needed.

Improvements to be made in the article
- Review title (English comprenhesion)
Author response: Thank you very much. We have changed the title a bit to increase comprehension. Hopefully the clarity is improved.

- Review abstract: Included number of articles in data extraction, not in results
Author response: Thank you very much. We have moved it to data extraction.

- Reviewing keywords, adding new ones
Author response: Thank you very much. We have put the domain of life as another keyword related to the main topic of the research.

- Table 2 should appear after referencing it in the text, not before.
Author response: Thank you very much. We have moved it in the right position.

- Explain the meaning of each acronym in the table (C, D...). Example Comunity (C)
Author response: The meaning of each acronym has been written under Table 2.

- Expand the study with data base Atlas.ti for grouping concepts in order to write so many subindex of references
Author response: We appreciate the recommendation of using Atlas.ti. We believe Atlas.ti would be a great use. One of the authors personally had experience in using this and it had helped her a lot plus made her work relatively faster to accomplish. Apologize if I understand the suggestion differently, yet during this stage, we are not able to use this software, as we don't have access to the free use and

aren’t able to buy the license due to its high price. The grouping was done through a modest technology (Ms.Excel). We were trying our best to give our best even to make the most out of it.

-Subdividing by items or subsection each domain to be more clear improving text comprehension

Author response: Thank you. We really appreciate this. We have taken the necessary step according to the suggestion. We put each domain under 2 subsections. First subsection is for the stigma manifestation and its driving factors and the second subsection is the stigma consequences.

- Explain more CASP in the explanation of the study selection

Author response: Thank you for your suggestion. We have added more information to improve the clarity

- In the reference of a figure, writting the text in the middle and with the reference corresponding (As an example in the document attached, it is in Spaninish but you can follow the reference and formatting template for tables and figures

Author response: The change has been made. The positioning of the title has been changed to the middle of the figure.

- Introduce the suplement material with the name of table and after to the text where you speak about them

Author response: We appreciate for this reminder. We have improved and check again to make sure accordingly.

- Lack of explanation of our limitations in our study. For example: difficulties to find documents, to read the documents, to choose the articles, to find the keywords.. (or others. It depends)

Author response: Thank you, we again appreciate this. We agree that the limitation part of our study was still very minimally inserted in the literature. We have added the limitation part in the discussion section.

- Part of the conclusions very terse

Author response: We have improved the conclusion so that it will sound well all the important points of this review.

I would like to congragulate your work in spite of my comments. Don´t hesitate to contact me if you have any question

Author response: Thank you very much Dr. Christina. We also thank you for the article you shared.

Reviewer: 4

Dr. Yudhy Dharmawan , University Medical Center Rotterdam Comments to the Author:

I believe this research is significant in revealing the domains of life affected by stigma towards leprosy-affected people in Indonesia, so it can help leprosy and social community program in Indonesia to overcome the impact of leprosy stigma in the community.

Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy for a very motivating statement for us. Hopefully, this research will give significant inputs.

To make this paper better readable for the readers and in line with the Systematic Review approach, I give my comments as follows: Objective :

Rows 3-4(Page 3):

Objective: To provide knowledge about the domains of life affected by stigma on leprosy affected persons in Indonesia, the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and consequences.

According to the PRISMA guideline (Please see checklist number 4), the objective must provide an explicit statement of questions being addressed with reference to participants, interventions, comparisons, outcomes, and study design (PICOS).
What are the 'Compare' and 'Outcome' in this objective? Will the authors make a comparison of the Intervention or not? Are the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and the consequences outcome? Please make it clear in the Objective section, so it can be a direction to analyse and discuss this study.
Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy for the question. We appreciate so much for giving an attention to this point. For this review, we used the qualitative systematic review approach thus as all the searched literature were qualitative/or had qualitative component in it.. For this type of review, instead of using PICO, we used PICo framework to formulate our objective and research question that is more suitable for the qualitative research. PICo stands for Population, Interest, and Context. Hereby, allow us to provide some links pertaining to this https://libguides.library.curtin.edu.au/c.php?g=863554&p=6191899; https://libguides.murdoch.edu.au/systematic/defining#s-lib-ctab-22166366-4; and an article by Butler et al. (2016) “Guide to writing a qualitative systematic review protocol” https://sigmapubs.onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/wvn.12134).

Following PICo then we wrote in the main article “To provide knowledge about the domains of life affected by stigma(Interest) on leprosy affected persons (Population) in Indonesia(Context), the manifestations of stigma (Interest), the driving factors (Interest) and consequences (Interest).” □ Allow us to fix the English comprehension of the objective writing. We have improved it to this: “To provide knowledge about leprosy affected persons’ (Population) domains of life of affected by stigma, including its stigma manifestations, driving factors and consequences (Interest) in Indonesia (Context).”

Method :
Rows 40-53 (Eligibility & Search Strategy) (Page 4)
The PICO(S) is not described in the method as the PRISMA guideline requirement (Please see checklist numbers 6 & 8). PICO(S) is very important to define the eligibility studies that can be included in the Systematic Review and the specific terms that will be used as the search strategy. Please state what is the Population, Intervention/Exposure, Compare, Outcome and Study design explicitly in the method section?
Author response: Thank you so much. We have added the PICo (population, interest, context) in the method section (the reason for using PICo instead of PICO(S) has been stated above.

The authors did not mention the kind of peer-reviewed and grey literature included in this study. Please state it explicitly and how did it conduct in this study? If there is no grey literature, please provide an argument about it.
Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy. We have added more information. Regarding grey literature, we have mentioned it before, yet we didn’t mention it clearly in the text. We have improved the text accordingly.

Rows 52-53 (Page 4):
Search terms used stigma, leprosy, driver, manifestations, and consequences and their synonyms as keywords.

What is the "search term" function in this method section? What is different with supplement material 1 (Syntaxes for search)? Did the authors do a double search strategy? What are the actual specific

terms that were used in the search strategy? Please explain it clearly in the method section. As long as my knowledge, the search strategy should be defined after describing the PICO(S).
Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy. There is no difference with supplement 1. We wrote it to help the readers who want to skim the article to find the search term thus they don't have to check the supplement. However, we realised now the issue has been solved as we follow your suggestion write the research question with PICo. We have now deleted the search term sentence to make it more concise.

Did the authors do a meta-analysis or only a narrative analysis? Please state this method explicitly in the method with its reason. As the mentioned in PRISMA guideline as the supplement material, this study provided meta-analysis results, but it is not written in the results section. Please explain this issue.
Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy, We did not do the meta-analysis. Apologize us, the PRISMA checklist that we used was the 2009. In the synthesis of result part of the 2009 PRISMA checklist, only meta-analysis type was provided. This differs with current 2020 PRISMA checklist that now is more open to the constantly evolving types of review analysis. We have modified our PRISMA checklist that could be found in the attached documents.

The authors did not explain the analysis and synthesis plan explicitly and clearly. It is only mentioned used Theme analysis (Row 7, page 5), but there is no description of this method's procedure, so that can make a result as written on pages 8-12. How did the authors categorise all the themes to be subgroup/subheadings as reported on pages 8-12? How did the authors analyse the stigma domain with the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and the consequences of stigma? Please explain the analysis and synthesis plan clearly in the method section so that it can give the analysis result as written in the result section.
Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy. We have incorporated the information about how we underwent the analysis in the main article.

Results
If possible, please make the crosstabulation of the stigma domain with the manifestations of stigma, the driving factors and the consequences of stigma to describe the results of analysis or synthesis in this study so the readers can see it easily in the summarising presented in the table.
This suggestion to meet the requirements of PRISMA guidelines (Please see checklist number 20)
Author response: Thank you Dr. Yudhy. We appreciate your suggestion. We agree that PRISMA emphasized an easy summary. However, as the findings were very rich and as for BMJ Open that only allowed to provide a maximum of 2 pages table, we searched for the best how to solve this. That is why we have come to the related information on Table 2. We believe what we provided in table 2 is a sufficient description of what we have found. We afraid we could not explain all in the table for the previous reasons we mentioned earlier. For the detail we have written it as a narration.

Please write the results according to the analysis and synthesis data plan that is mentioned in the method section.
Author response: Thank you very much. We appreciate your concern on this. However, as the main purpose of the result is to highlight the domain of life, we decided to make it as a narrative under each analytical theme. We incorporated this new sentence to the main article so that the reader could follow well how we plan to present the structure of the findings.

Discussion
I suggest providing the main finding in this study, for instance, the predominant stigma domain in LAP of Indonesia in the summary part of the discussion section and discussing this factor to overcome the stigma among LAP in Indonesia.

Author response: Thank you Dr Yudhi. With respect, we have written the main finding in this study has been written in the discussion. For example, regarding the predominant stigma domain, we have written it in the second paragraph. Suggestions to overcome in what was found in each domain have been also written in the sixth paragraph. We could not say what is predominant in Indonesia, we only could say what is predominant in the literature, as at this state there were a lack of literature discuses stigma in certain domains such as in education and in public entitlement and from our coverage findings the amount of literature cannot be said to be evenly distributed to make a just conclusion.

There is no discussion about the limitation of this study as the requirement of the PRISMA Guideline (Please see checklist number 25) Author response: Thank you, we appreciate this. We agree that the limitation part of our study was still very minimally inserted in the main article. We have added the limitation part in the discussion section.

The conclusion is very general. There is no specific finding that can be revealed from this study. I believe if the authors can revise the objective according to the PICOS criteria, this study's interesting conclusion can be made because the results and discussion will be more focused.
Author response: : We appreciate the suggestion. Thank you very much. We have improved the conclusion so that it will sound well all the important points of this review and the PICo We have improved the conclusion so that it will sound well all the important points of this review and the PICo.

Supplement material:
Please the authors check and revise the supplement material of the PRISMA guideline, especially the page number that contains the item checklist and also, please mention the number supplement material specifically. Many checklist items are not appropriate for text/manuscript pages. Several checklist entries were claimed in the text, but nothing was written in the text as per my comment above after I checked.
Author response: We apologize for this. We really appreciate the input. We had some difficulties to incorporate the PRISMA 2009. Now, we changed the PRISMA 2009 to PRISMA 2020 as also suggested by the editor. As we mentioned earlier, PRISMA 2020 allowed for a wide types of review analysis. We hope that now the PRISMA checklist is appropriate for the manuscript.

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Yudhy Dharmawan University Medical Center Rotterdam, Public Health
REVIEW RETURNED	08-Sep-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	All my comments and suggestions were well addressed